

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, breezy, cooler, showers from midday on, high 69. **Tonight**, evening showers, cloudy, low 52. **Tomorrow**, clouds and sun, breezy, high 61. Weather map appears on Page A24.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



Cardón Refinery in Punto Fijo, Venezuela. The oil industry is a core part of the country’s national identity, though decades of plundering have left it deeply corrupted.

Israeli Settlers Widen Attacks In West Bank

This article is by **Natan Odenheimer, David M. Halbfinger and Fatima AbdulKarim.**

KHIRBET ABU FALAH, West Bank — When Israeli settlers attacked his West Bank village, Moatasem Odeh saw his son Amir, 28, fatally shot. Then he was stabbed repeatedly and beaten unconscious.

The attack in Qusra, on March 14, was one of many in a wave of brutal violence in the West Bank over the past two months.

Villagers might have once driven the attackers away by throwing stones, said Mr. Odeh, 46, but settlers now routinely carry guns. “We are helpless,” he said, “and they know it.”

With the world’s attention focused on the U.S.-Israeli war with Iran and its proxies, extremist settlers acting with seeming impunity have intensified their attacks on Palestinians across the Israeli-occupied West Bank. Their campaign of violence and intimidation is emptying out entire villages and leaving countless Palestinians fearing what each nightfall might bring.

In the Jordan Valley, masked men sexually assaulted Suhaib Abualkebash, 29, and brutalized his extended family, children included.

In Deir Dibwan, east of Ramallah, Odeh Awawdeh, 25, was fatally shot when he tried to stop settlers from stealing his family’s sheep, according to his family and local authorities.

Thaer Hamayel, 28, was shot dead fending off Israeli settlers raiding his village, Khirbet Abu Falah.

“I’m afraid of being in my

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Her Mission: Track Killer That Leaves Few Clues

By **JAN HOFFMAN**

KNOXVILLE, Tenn. — The chief medical examiner was not satisfied. The toxicology report on the dead man’s blood samples made no sense, given what her investigator had noted at the death scene:

Oct. 26, 2025, 2:43 a.m. Apartment, South Knoxville, Tenn. Decedent: white man, 52, supine on bed, in T-shirt, pants, belt, socks. In the bathroom: thumbnail-size baggies, cut straws, dollar bill, hollow pen, white powder.

But the only substances a laboratory found in his blood were nicotine and caffeine.

THE NEW DRUG WAR

Orphines Hit the Street

“Please look harder, please look harder,” implored Dr. Darinka Mileusnic-Polchan, the chief medical examiner for the greater Knoxville area. “Can’t we do something else?”

She sent the samples to a second lab. It found sedatives, but not enough to explain the death. She sent them to a third lab, which specializes in detecting novel drugs.

Those results were alarming: The victim had overdosed on cyclophosphine, a compound in a new

class of opioids called orphines that are 10 times more powerful than fentanyl.

In the six months since his death, at least 50 fatal overdoses involving cyclophosphine have been confirmed in the greater Knoxville area. The largely unknown compound is on track to be the third-most-common drug involved in the region’s fatal overdoses this year, after fentanyl and methamphetamine.

Over that period, Knoxville became a national hot spot for cyclophosphine. But if it were not for Dr. Mileusnic’s tenacity, the community would probably not even know the drug was circulating.

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Little Clarity On Oil Money After Maduro

By **ANATOLY KURMANAEV**

U.S. and Venezuelan officials have promised a new era of accountability for Venezuela’s lucrative oil industry after the downfall of President Nicolás Maduro.

President Trump said the United States would control Venezuelan oil sales. Venezuela would submit monthly budgets to the White House, the Trump administration said, and the United States said it hired auditors to check receipts.

Venezuela’s new leader and Mr. Trump’s ally, Delcy Rodríguez, said the public could trace every oil dollar on a new website.

None of these initiatives, however, have thus far shed light on where Venezuela’s oil money has been going, prompting questions about the political will in Washington and Caracas.

Yet even with the best intentions, Washington’s plan to show how and where Venezuela’s oil riches are being spent would be a gargantuan task. Decades of plundering have left Venezuela with an opaque and deeply corrupt oil industry, which Ms. Rodríguez had largely failed to solve during her previous role running the national economy.

For every two dollars that Venezuela earned selling oil earlier this decade, one dollar was stolen, internal documents and official statistics show.

The stakes are even higher today. For Mr. Trump, his plan to unlock Venezuela’s massive oil potential with \$100 billion of American investment hinges in part on convincing U.S. oil executives that his administration can establish the rule of law.

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ASIM HAFEEZ FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Despite Deadly Attacks, the Train Keeps Running

Separatists have besieged the Jaffer Express, a lifeline in a restive Pakistani province. Page A4.

REPUBLICANS SEEK \$1 BILLION TO USE FOR A BALLROOM

CITING SECURITY NEEDS

Public Money Is Targeted for a Project Billed as Privately Financed

By **CARL HULSE**

WASHINGTON — Senate Republicans have inserted \$1 billion for White House East Wing security enhancements in the immigration enforcement funding bill they hope to rush through Congress this month, setting up a political fight over a ballroom that President Trump has said would be financed with private money.

The leaders of the Judiciary and Homeland Security Committees on Monday released plans for the roughly \$70 billion package, which would significantly bolster spending on Immigration and Customs Enforcement and border patrol through the end of Mr. Trump’s term using a party-line legislative process that can skirt a filibuster.

A surprise addition to the measure was the \$1 billion proposed by the Judiciary Committee for security work related to Mr. Trump’s East Wing renovation. The measure does not mention the president’s proposed new ballroom, which is being challenged in court, but Mr. Trump has insisted that a main reason for the project is to enhance security.

While the president has insisted that the renovation would be funded through private donations, a spokesman on Tuesday said the White House applauded the proposed security funding for a “long overdue” project.

Mr. Trump and congressional Republicans have escalated their efforts to defend the project after the shooting last month at the White House correspondents’ dinner attended by the president.

The bill says the public money would be directed to “security adjustments and upgrades, including within the perimeter fence of the White House compound to support enhancements by the Secret Service relating to the East Wing Modernization Project, including above-ground and below-ground security features.” It also bars any of the funding from being spent on “non-security elements.”

But Democrats pounced on the proposal, signaling that they intended to make the ballroom a

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DOUG MILLS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Construction on the White House ballroom last month.

He’s Pro-Climate, but His Firm Was Big on Coal

This article is by **Danny Hakim, Julie Tate and Laurel Rosenhall.**

Tom Steyer, one of the front-runners in the California governor’s race, has said that he “walked away” from the hedge fund he managed years ago to “focus full-time on fighting climate change.”

Mr. Steyer did step down as the chief executive of Farallon Capital, one of the nation’s largest hedge fund firms, in 2012. But his

Old Ties Haunt Steyer’s Run in California

financial records show that he never fully cut ties with the investment firm he founded even as it solidified its role in recent years as a major lender to the coal industry as mainstream banks faced environmentalist pressure to stop funding coal mining.

Mr. Steyer has become a leading Democratic contender in the California governor’s race since the sudden withdrawal of Eric Swalwell last month. His wealth, and how he got rich, has become a focal point in the race, given growing voter concerns about the influence of billionaires.

Mr. Steyer’s campaign says that he has asked Farallon to separate his funds from the company’s investments in fossil fuels. But it is

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F.D.A. Pulled Studies Showing Safety of Vaccines

By **CHRISTINA JEWETT**

WASHINGTON — Officials at the Food and Drug Administration have blocked publication of several studies supporting the safety of widely used vaccines against Covid-19 and shingles in recent months, a spokesman for the Department of Health and Human Services confirmed.

The studies, which cost millions of dollars in public funds, were conducted by scientists at the

No Publication of Covid and Shingles Findings

agency, who worked with data companies to analyze millions of patient records. They found serious side effects to be very rare.

In October, the scientists were directed to withdraw two Covid-19 vaccine studies that had been accepted for publication in medical

journals. In February, top F.D.A. officials did not sign off on submitting abstracts about studies of Shingrix, a shingles vaccine, to a major drug safety conference.

The withdrawal of the studies is the latest step by the administration to try to limit access to vaccines. It has sharply cut research funding for vaccine development, released unvetted information casting doubt on vaccines and blocked other information sup-

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NATIONAL A13-21

Home on the Range No More

The administration, siding with ranchers, is evicting bison herds from federal grasslands in Montana. PAGE A13

Georgia Poll Workers Targeted

The Justice Department appears to be relying on debunked claims that Democrats stole the 2020 election. PAGE A16

INTERNATIONAL A4-12

‘Gates to Hell’ Aren’t as Bright

A flaming crater of gas has burned in Turkmenistan for decades. The fires are decreasing, but the environmental implications are unclear. PAGE A12

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Embracing Electric Vehicles

Spiking fuel prices accelerate a trend in Costa Rica and other countries in Latin America, Asia and Africa. PAGE B1

A.I. Won’t Kill Off Meetings

The human work of cajoling, twisting arms and reassuring appears to be rising in importance. PAGE B1



SPORTS B7-10

Prodigy Against Mentor

Rudy Gobert has guided Victor Wembanyama since he was a high school hot shot. Now they’re doing battle. PAGE B7

Young and Hunting for a Title

Four of the five teams with the lowest average ages in the N.H.L. made the second round of the playoffs. PAGE B9

FOOD D1-8

Try Loving Less Food More

Maybe our weight problems aren’t caused by liking food too much. What if, some experts ask, the real issue is that we’re not enjoying it enough? PAGE D1

OBITUARIES B11-12

Gold Medalist With a Burden

Steve Clark, an Olympic swimmer in the 1960s, dealt with depression at a time when doing so was seen as weakness. He was 82. PAGE B12

OPINION A22-23

Michelle Goldberg

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ARTS C1-6

New Shows Lead Tony List

The musicals “Schmigadoon!” and “Lost Boys” (with L. J. Benet, left, and Ali Louis Bourzgui) earned more nominations than any other show. PAGE C1



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